Gmail

David Wise <r.giskard.01@gmail.com>

Sarah Sonmor Wise

10 messages

David Wise <r.giskard.01@gmail.com> Fri, Jan 23, 2026 at 11:16 AM
To: corourke@hesslawoffice.net

Subject: Request for Billing Records and Client File for Sarah Sonmor-Wise

Dear Ms. O'Rourke,

I hope this email finds you well. I am writing on behalf of my wife, Sarah Sonmor-Wise, your former client in her divorce and related custody matters from 2019 to 2026. As you are aware, Sarah has provided written authorization for me to access and discuss information related to her representation, including all financial and billing details. A copy of this release should be on file with your office today or later today.

We greatly appreciate the services provided during this time and understand that family law cases can involve ongoing needs. However, to ensure a complete understanding of the financial aspects and to verify the outstanding balance of approximately $1,900 that was mentioned, we kindly request a full set of records. This will help us review the payments made—estimated at around $30,000 + over the six years—and confirm that everything aligns with the work performed, particularly given the lower activity in recent years.

While I am unsure of the exact communications Sarah may have received, she has never mentioned details such as an evergreen retainer structure, trust fund arrangements, or billable hours. Her understanding was focused solely on maintaining a $1,500 account balance at the end of every month, and that this balance appeared to deplete even when it seemed no services were being rendered, which has led to our current questions.

Specifically, please provide the following within the next 14 days:

1. A complete copy of the original signed retainer/fee agreement from 2019, including any amendments or updates.
2. All billing statements or invoices issued from 2019 to 2026, detailing charges, payments, and balances.
3. Detailed time entries for all services rendered, including the date, description of the task, time spent (in tenths of hours), hourly rate, and amount billed.
4. The full trust account ledger, showing all deposits (including the initial retainer and any monthly replenishments), withdrawals (with dates, amounts, and

corresponding services), and the final balance, including any unearned fees eligible for refund.

5. The entire client file, including correspondence, court documents, and any notes related to the case.

Providing these materials will allow us to clarify any questions and bring this matter to a fair resolution. If there are any reasonable copying or retrieval costs as outlined in the fee agreement, please provide an estimate in advance.

Please send the documents to our address in Buffalo, MN (on file) or electronically to [Sarah's email and this email]. If you need any additional information to process this request, let me know promptly.

Thank you for your attention to this. We value clear communication and look forward to receiving these items soon.

Best regards,
David Wise

763-242-0340

R.giskard01@gmail.com
Buffalo, MN

Caitlin O'Rourke <corourke@hesslawoffice.net> Fri, Jan 23, 2026 at 1:15 PM
To: David Wise <r.giskard.01@gmail.com>
Cc: Sarah sonmor Wise <ssonmorwise@gmail.com>

Mr. Wise,

I cannot speak with you about this matter until Ms. Sonmor Wise signs a Release of Authorization ("ROI") AND she calls my office to speak with me.

I have given my staff the same directive that we can not speak with you further UNTIL we have the ROI and Ms. Sonmor Wise speaks with me.

I am in the office until 4 PM today.

Sincerely,

Caitlin

Caitlin E. O'Rourke

Attorney

11070 183rd Circle NW, Suite A

Elk River, MN 55330

Phone: 763-241-4855

Fax: 763-274-1452

www.HessLawOffice.net

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David Wise <r.giskard.01@gmail.com> Fri, Jan 23, 2026 at 1:23 PM
To: Caitlin O'Rourke <corourke@hesslawoffice.net>

Mrs. O'Rourke

Thank you for your response.

I understand and respect that you cannot discuss client matters with me without a signed Release of Authorization, and Ms. Sonmor Wise will be emailing shortly regarding that authorization.

I do want to clarify one point, however. My understanding is that Ms. Sonmor Wise's access to her own records — including her fee agreement, trust account ledger, and billing history — is not contingent upon a phone call, but rather upon her request as the former client.

To be clear, we are not seeking discussion or narrative explanation at this stage. We are requesting production of the documents necessary to reconcile the account and understand the basis for the claimed balance. Any discussion can occur after those records have been reviewed.

If I am mistaken as to the process, please let me know. Otherwise, we will proceed with Ms. Sonmor Wise making a written request for the documents directly.

Thank you for your clarification.

Regards,

David Wise

Sent from my iPhone

On Jan 23, 2026, at 1:15 PM, Caitlin O'Rourke <corourke@hesslawoffice.net> wrote:

Mr. Wise,

I cannot speak with you about this matter until Ms. Sonmor Wise signs a Release of Authorization ("ROI") AND she calls my office to speak with me.

I have given my staff the same directive that we can not speak with you further UNTIL we have the ROI and Ms. Sonmor Wise speaks with me.

I am in the office until 4 PM today.

Sincerely,

Caitlin

Caitlin E. O'Rourke

Attorney

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Caitlin O'Rourke <corourke@hesslawoffice.net> Fri, Jan 23, 2026 at 1:25 PM
To: David Wise <r.giskard.01@gmail.com>
Cc: "ssonmorwise@gmail.com" <ssonmorwise@gmail.com>

Mr. Wise,

As I stated, Ms. Sonmor Wise must speak with me and she must sign an ROI.

I need her to confirm the ROI verbally.

Caitlin

Caitlin E. O'Rourke

Attorney

11070 183rd Circle NW, Suite A

[Quoted text hidden]
[Quoted text hidden]

David Wise <r.giskard.01@gmail.com> Fri, Jan 23, 2026 at 1:32 PM
To: Caitlin O'Rourke <corourke@hesslawoffice.net>

Ms. O'Rourke,

Thank you for the clarification.

I understand the need for a written Release of Authorization for you to communicate with me. Ms. Sonmor Wise will provide that authorization in writing.

I do want to clarify, however, that Ms. Sonmor Wise is no longer your client, and as a former client she is entitled to copies of her own records—specifically her fee/engagement agreement, complete trust account ledger, and billing history—upon request. My understanding is that production of those records is not contingent upon a verbal conversation, but rather upon the former client's written request.

At this stage, we are not requesting discussion or explanation. We are requesting the records themselves so the account can be reconciled. Any conversation can occur after the documents have been reviewed, if needed.

If there is a specific ethical or procedural requirement that necessitates verbal confirmation prior to producing a former client's records, please identify it. Otherwise, Ms. Sonmor Wise will proceed with a written request for the documents.

Thank you for your attention to this matter.

Respectfully,

David wise
Sent from my iPhone

> On Jan 23, 2026, at 1:25 PM, Caitlin O'Rourke <corourke@hesslawoffice.net> wrote:
>
> Mr. Wise,
>
> As I stated, Ms. Sonmor Wise must speak with me and she must sign an ROI.
>
> [Quoted text hidden]

Caitlin O'Rourke <corourke@hesslawoffice.net> Fri, Jan 23, 2026 at 1:42 PM
To: David Wise <r.giskard.01@gmail.com>

Mr. Wise,

Again, I need to speak with Ms. Sonmor Wise and have her sign an ROI.

Sincerely,

Caitlin

Caitlin E. O'Rourke

Attorney

11070 183rd Circle NW, Suite A

Elk River, MN 55330

Phone: 763-241-4855

Fax: 763-274-1452

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From: David Wise <r.giskard.01@gmail.com>
Sent: Friday, January 23, 2026 1:32 PM
To: Caitlin O'Rourke <corourke@hesslawoffice.net>
Subject: Re: Sarah Sonmor Wise

Ms. O'Rourke,

[Quoted text hidden]

David Wise <r.giskard.01@gmail.com> Fri, Jan 23, 2026 at 1:51 PM
To: Caitlin O'Rourke <corourke@hesslawoffice.net>

Mrs. O'Rourke.

I understand you may not speak to me about Sarah's information, and she will be emailing you shortly an roi for me to have on file.

Have a great weekend.

Sent from my iPhone

On Jan 23, 2026, at 1:42 PM, Caitlin O'Rourke <corourke@hesslawoffice.net> wrote:

Mr. Wise,

Again, I need to speak with Ms. Sonmor Wise and have her sign an ROI.

Sincerely,

Caitlin

Caitlin E. O'Rourke

Attorney

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Caitlin O'Rourke <corourke@hesslawoffice.net> Fri, Jan 23, 2026 at 1:54 PM
To: David Wise <r.giskard.01@gmail.com>
Cc: "ssonmorwise@gmail.com" <ssonmorwise@gmail.com>

Mr. Wise,

I am concerned that you will be using Ms. Sonmor Wise' email. during the entire 6 years I worked with her, I've never had contact with you or a ROI.

Again, I need an ROI and a verbal request from my client for her file. I am here until 4 PM.

Caitlin

Caitlin E. O'Rourke

Attorney

11070 183rd Circle NW, Suite A

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[Quoted text hidden]

David Wise <r.giskard.01@gmail.com> Mon, Feb 2, 2026 at 5:30 PM
To: Caitlin O'Rourke <corourke@hesslawoffice.net>

I am responding to this marketing email to request accommodation information.

I require email-based communication due to personal circumstances. Please do not direct me to phone support.

My question: [Insert Flaming Dragon inquiry—product accessibility, store accommodation policy, whatever the standard test is]

Please confirm this inquiry has been received and routed appropriately.

[Quoted text hidden]

David Wise <r.giskard.01@gmail.com> Mon, Feb 2, 2026 at 5:44 PM
To: Caitlin O'Rourke <corourke@hesslawoffice.net>

To: Caitlin O'Rourke (corourke@hesslawoffice.net)

Subject: Debt Dispute — $951.21 Collection Notice Dated January 30, 2026

Ms. O'Rourke,

I am writing in response to the collection notice dated January 30, 2026 in the amount of $951.21, referencing Wright County File 86-FA-20-621.

This debt affects my household. I have standing to dispute it.

I am formally disputing this debt.

To validate the claimed balance, I am requesting the following:

1. Itemized accounting showing how $951.21 was calculated
2. The original signed fee agreement establishing the basis for this obligation
3. Billing statements showing charges, payments, and running balances
4. Time entries corresponding to billed services
5. Trust account ledger showing deposits and withdrawals

These records are necessary to determine whether this balance is accurate and owed.

For the record:

On January 23, 2026, I requested these same records. You refused to produce them. You demanded a phone call as a precondition — a requirement that does not exist under Minnesota ethics rules for former client file production.

Seven days later, you sent a collection notice for a balance you have not substantiated.

You cannot collect on a debt you refuse to document.

Communication requirements:

I have a disability that requires email-based communication. Do not contact me by phone. Do not condition the resolution of this dispute on a phone call. This is reasonable accommodation.

All further communication regarding this matter must be in writing via email to r.giskard.01@gmail.com.

Additionally:

You communicated with me directly four times on January 23, 2026. You CC'd Sarah Sonmor-Wise on three of those emails, creating a three-party thread. You did this voluntarily, without an ROI in place, while simultaneously claiming you could not communicate with me.

Regarding this debt dispute: direct all further communication to me only at r.giskard.01@gmail.com. Do not contact Sarah Sonmor-Wise regarding this collection matter. If Sarah wishes to communicate with you separately about her former client file, that is her decision.

Produce the records or withdraw the collection.

David Wise r.giskard.01@gmail.com Email only
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